Day 26 - Bennett Heritage Trail, Maureen Smith, Snows Creek, Silver Creek, Eighth Line

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 35 · Silver Creek and Scotsdale Farm

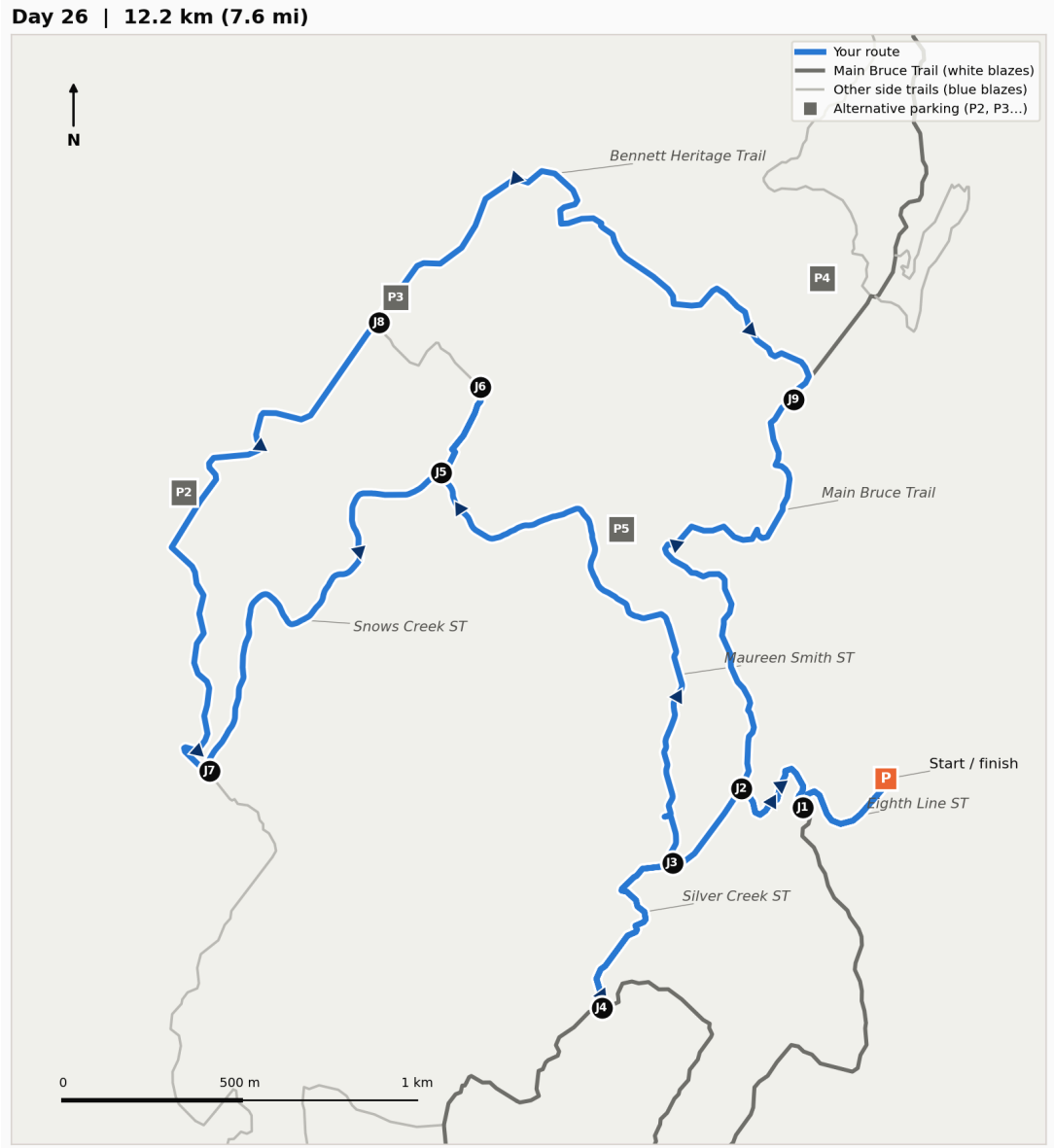
12.2 km / 7.6 mi	~3.4 h	8.5 km new	47 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking across from the Eighth Line Side Trail on Eighth Line. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day26_hike035.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Bennett Heritage Trail (3.8 km); Maureen Smith Side Trail (2.3 km); Snows Creek Side Trail (1.4 km); Silver Creek Side Trail (0.6 km); Eighth Line Side Trail (0.4 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on Eighth Line across from the Eighth Line Side Trail. Parking in the Silver Creek area is roadside only and can fill on weekends from 11 a.m. to 5 p.m.; there are no washrooms.
- **Maureen Smith and Silver Creek side trails:** Lengthened and reworked in the July 2026 reconfiguration. Credit Valley Conservation rates both difficult: Maureen Smith has steep sections with rocks and boulders, and the short Silver Creek Side Trail crosses streams on its way to the main Trail.

- **Snows Creek Side Trail:** Now a 3.6 km side trail after the July 2026 changes, leading toward Scotsdale Farm. No published description of its terrain was found.
- **Bennett Heritage Trail:** Starts at Scotsdale Farm and passes a pond with a weeping willow, then crosses Snow's Creek and Owl Creek. CVC rates it difficult.
- **Main Trail:** CVC rates the Bruce Trail here strenuous, with escarpment views, wooden bridges and long steep climbs. Silver Creek trails in general have steep slopes, rocks and roots; CVC recommends carrying a Bruce Trail map.
- **Older maps:** After the July 2026 Silver Creek reconfiguration, the Duff Pit, Trafalgar and Great Esker side trails no longer appear under those names; parts became main Trail or were renamed. Follow the current blazes and the guide's directions.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Scotsdale Farm: Enter from Trafalgar Rd, 1.7 km northwest of Highway 7 map	Free	6.9	0 m	Bennett Heritage Trail
P3	In the laneway off the west side of Eighth Line where the Bennett Heritage Trail crosses map	Free	7.8	120 m	Bennett Heritage Trail
P4	Silver Creek Education Centre: Enter from Fallbrook Trail northwest of the 27th Sideroad map	Free	9.8	1200 m	
P5	Roadside parking on the eastern shoulder of Eighth Line at the southernmost intersection with... map	Free	10.6	190 m	

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 6.8 km / 4.2 mi, covering Eighth Line, Maureen Smith, Silver Creek. **Outing 2** from P2 (Scotsdale Farm: Enter from Trafalgar Rd, 1.7 km northwest of Highway 7; Free): 7.9 km / 4.9 mi, covering Bennett Heritage Trail, Maureen Smith, Snows Creek. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking across from the Eighth Line Side Trail on Eighth Line. Head south on the blue-blazed Eighth Line Side Trail.
0.4	0.2	J1: Turn sharp right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
0.8	0.5	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Maureen Smith Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
1.1	0.7	J3: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Silver Creek Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Maureen Smith Side Trail goes off on your right.)
1.7	1.0	J4: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
2.3	1.4	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Maureen Smith Side Trail, heading north. (the Maureen Smith Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
4.0	2.5	J5: Junction. Turn right to stay on the Maureen Smith Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Snows Creek Side Trail goes off on your left.)
4.3	2.7	J6: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
4.6	2.8	J5: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Snows Creek Side Trail, heading south-west. (the Maureen Smith Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
6.0	3.7	J7: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Bennett Heritage Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Snows Creek Side Trail goes off on your left.)
7.8	4.8	J8: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Bennett Heritage Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Maureen Smith Side Trail goes off on your right.) There is trailhead parking here (In the laneway off the west side of Eighth Line where the Bennett Heritage Trail crosses).
9.8	6.1	J9: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
11.4	7.1	J2: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the Maureen Smith Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
11.8	7.3	J1: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed Eighth Line Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
12.2	7.6	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Credit Valley Conservation, a Bruce Trail Conservancy trail-change notice and Ontario Nature Trails.